

Assignment 1 - Git & GitHub Fundamentals Report

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1. Repository Setup

The STARTER files were copied into GitLab-repo and initialized with `git init`. The `.gitignore` rules are `local.env`, `*.log`, and `!important.log`. `git check-ignore -v` verified the ignored files; `important.log` is tracked.

2. README & Commit History

The README contains the name, username, description, technologies, one code block, one link, and the provided image. Commits separate setup, README, homepage, notes, and About changes. History excerpt from `git log --oneline --all`:

```
3c0517d Add remote README sentence for fetch and pull 3f25403 Merge About
feature into main
e5a2c1d Add About section on the about branch b94f9c4 Record the status
check before staging 01d8d34 Clarify the homepage Git workflow overview
269752d Add README with project details and starter banner 787a67c Initialize starter
project and ignore local files
```

3. Selective Staging

`index.html` and `notes.txt` were changed together. `git add index.html` staged only `index.html`. Commit `01d8d34` saved it while `notes.txt` remained modified, then `notes.txt` was committed separately. `git status --short` before the first commit showed:

```
M index.html M
notes.txt
```

4. Branch & Merge

`git branch about` and `git checkout about` created and selected the About branch. The About section was committed there, then `git checkout main` and `git merge about` merged it. A checkout attempted before creating about failed; creating the branch fixed it.

5. Remote Changes

An empty GitHub repository was created. `git remote add origin` connected it, and `git push -u origin main` published main. Commit saves changes locally; push uploads commits. The README sentence was edited on GitHub. `git fetch origin` left the local README unchanged and status showed main behind origin/main by one commit. `git pull origin main` brought the sentence locally.

A status-message change was inspected with `git diff app.js` before staging and `git diff --staged` after staging. Both diff excerpts showed:

```
- statusMessage.textContent = "Starter project is ready.";
+ statusMessage.textContent = "Session 1 Git project is ready.";
```

6. Fair Use of AI

As much of the commands that I had to use I am exposed to for the first time. I relied heavily on ChatGPT to guide me and provide me with the steps that I followed to complete the entirety of the assignment.

7. Sources & Reflection

The hardest distinction is that fetch updates remote information while pull updates the current branch. If Git behaves unexpectedly, first check git status, the current branch, and git remote -v.